

Exercise

Exercise is good for the body and the brain. It keeps teens' bodies healthy, improves memory and sleep quality, and boosts confidence.

SEE ALSO

◀ 68–69 Healthy eating

◀ 70–71 Eating disorders

◀ 72–73 Body image

Stress

92–93 ▶

Being active

Teens should try to include some form of physical exercise in their day, every day. They should aim for a mix of activities throughout the week, at varied intensity levels, in order to build muscle and bone strength and maintain cardiovascular fitness.

► Recommended amounts for teens

Teens should aim to get at least 60 minutes of some form of physical activity every day.

Finding balance

During stressful periods, such as when homework starts to pile up, finding the time to exercise can be hard. But, in fact, exercise can be a great stress reliever. If setting aside a chunk of time to exercise is tricky, fitting a small amount of physical activity into the day can still make a difference, such as using the stairs instead of taking the elevator.



Physical inactivity: in small doses
Limit the amount of physical inactivity in a day.



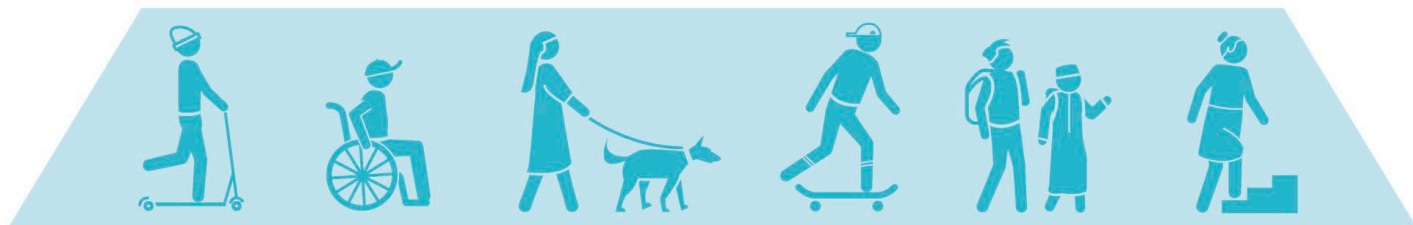
Moderate: 2–3 times per week
During moderate aerobic exercise, it should be possible to talk but the body should sweat and the heart rate should be raised.

Try activities that improve both muscle and bone strength, such as swimming.



Vigorous: 3 times per week
Vigorous exercise includes anything that raises the heart rate and gets a teen breathing heavily. It shouldn't be possible to talk easily.

Set challenges, such as sprints, to elevate the heart rate.



Light physical activity: daily
Many everyday physical activities that keep a teen moving about can help them stay healthy, too.